

Extension Proposal

I. Project Title: **HANAS: A Capability Building for Improved Market Access for Traditional Crafts of the Ati Community**

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III: Rationale

The Municipality of Dumarao, a second-class municipality in the Province of Capiz, is identified by the Provincial Tourism as one of the homes of Indigenous Peoples (IPs) in the province. The Ati, a group of indigenous people from Dumarao, have developed artistic skills and craftsmanship that are mostly value driven and have cultural underpinning. These are prevalently expressed in traditional arts and crafts like bags, earrings, baskets, and other decorative aesthetics made of *nito*, a plant belonging to the fern family that grows abundantly in the place.

As the tourism industry progresses in the province, the demand for artisanal products like bags, baskets, and decorative aesthetics also increases. Many producers are engaged in this production as their source of income. Unfortunately, these local producers could hardly sell their products due to several factors such as market access, transportation, etc.

More so, the Ati, who also produce handicrafts driven by their rich traditional arts, is somewhat left behind in terms of commercialization. Imports from other places and huge companies/businesses overshadow their local products. Worse, the commercialization of these handicrafts in the low-end market has eventually pushed down the quality value and price, giving them a low income and an unsustainable livelihood. Before the pandemic, the Ati people were already marginalized from society due to cultural differences. It worsened when the pandemic began and continues over the year (Bicular, 2021).

Today, the traditional arts and crafts of the Ati are becoming a vanishing trade due to poor marketing and capitalization deficiency. In this premise, this project titled Hanas: A Capability Building for Improved Market Access for Traditional Crafts of the Ati Community is conceptualized to train and capacitate the Ati in Dumarao, Capiz, in terms of marketing their culture-based arts and crafts to promote sustainable livelihood, especially this pandemic. *Hanas* is a Hiligaynon term that means training, practicing, or rehearsing. *Hanas*, the local term for training, will be a training design for the Ati community in Dumarao, particularly on improving market access and selling their local products to augment their source of living.

A study conducted by Bicular et al. (2022) focused on preserving the culture of the Ati people in Capiz by documenting their arts, crafts, practices, and livelihood within their day-to-day lives. This can be used as basis for the instructional materials that can be used in constructing the training design for the Ati people.

IV. Objectives

Entrepreneurship is believed to improve the economic strength and innovation of countries, cities, neighborhoods, and communities (Mason et al., 2015). From this perspective, the rise of various forms of capability building is relevant to capacitate people. The government is even emphasizing active citizenship by encouraging them to take responsibility and empower themselves with skills, especially on improved market access, to fill in gaps brought by poverty. Improved market access enables local producers to sell their goods and services across borders. It helps draw attraction and attention to potential customers.

The training on capacitating the Ati community in improving their market access will be essential among the members of the Ati Community in Dumarao, Capiz. The Ati have existing products in arts and crafts. However, with the onslaught of the pandemic, they can hardly market these products due to border restrictions. Hence, this capacity training aims to capacitate the Ati community, especially the youth and the elders, in selling their local products using social platforms to become economically sustainable and resilient individuals. (Biclar, 2021).

Generally, this training intends to capacitate 25 IP participants (youth and elders) in marketing their arts and crafts using digital technology and social media platform. Specifically, it aims to:

1. Train the IP youth and elders on utilizing digital technology and social media platforms for promotion and online marketing of their traditional and local crafts.
2. Create social media page for promotion and online marketing of IP artisans' traditional and local crafts.

V. Activities/Methodologies

The following are the activities to be done to achieve the desired output:

1. Strategic planning of the project. The project team will convene to design a strategic plan for the training, especially on what kind of training will be conducted, persons to be involved in the activity, trainers to be invited, type of training, venue, participants, and other training needs.
2. Seeking Permission from the NCIP/Chieftain. Before the training, a letter of permission will be sent to the NCIP or Chieftain asking for consent to involve the Ati of the Dumarao, Capiz, in a three-day face-to-face capability training that focuses on utilizing digital technology and online marketing.
3. Meeting with Chieftain. Conduct a courtesy call with the Chieftain of the Ati to explain the project's purpose. The project team will then explain to the Chieftain the possible training flow, the kind of training to be delivered, potential participants, training procedure, the expected output, and benefits to their community.
4. Identification of Trainees. Trainees will be identified based on the recommendation of the Chieftain of the Ati Community in consideration of the objectives of the training design.

a. Conduct of Training. The training will be conducted face-to-face for three (2) days following the IATF protocols. The first training day will be spent on inventory and photographing their local crafts and products. The second day will be a lecture, demonstration, and workshop. Participants will be taught how to utilize digital technology, mainly social media platforms, to promote and market their local crafts. This includes uploading and making descriptions of their local crafts. The third day will be spent on output presentation and critiquing. A certificate of participation will also be given to the participants and trainer on the third day. photo off will also be done.

In the conduct of the training, the following protocols will be observed:

- b. Registering a maximum of 25 participants and observing physical distancing strictly.
- c. Onsite training will be held in a school or spacious space/conference room.
- d. Observance of maximum health protocols by wearing face masks, physical distancing, temperature check, and log book. Participants who are not observing the said protocols and not feeling well will not be allowed to participate in the training. Contact tracing forms will also be made available before the start of the training.

VI. Work Plan

Project Activities	Timeframe 2023			
	June	July	August	September
Strategic planning of the conduct of training				
Seeking permissions from concerned authorities.				
Courtesy call with Chieftain				
Training Preparation to include the invitation of trainers and participants				
Conduct of Training Program				
Preparation of Training Reports				
Submission of Reports and Training Outputs NCCA				

VII. Outputs and Impacts

The following are the expected outputs:

1. Facebook page of the Ati Community promotes and markets their traditional and local crafts online
2. Creating of a Training Design tailored to the needs of the Ati people.

3. Video Documentation of the Training

VIII. Monitoring and Evaluation

The monitoring tool used for evaluation will be the socio-economic assessment tool currently utilized within the research and projects under the SSITRDC. This will be conducted twice (before and after the project's intervention) to assess the impact of the intervention activities.

IX. Budgetary Requirements

Nature of Expense	Particulars	Counterpart Funding	Funding Requested from NCCA	Total
1. Personal Services				
Project Director	Php 13, 000.00 x 1 pax		Php 13, 000.00	Php 13, 000.00
Assistant Project Director	Php 12, 000.00 x 1 pax		Php 12, 000.00	Php 12, 000.00
Training Coordinator	Php 11, 000 x 1 pax		Php 11, 000.00	Php 11, 000.00
Training Facilitators	Php 5, 000 x 2 pax		Php 10, 000.00	Php 10, 000.00
2. MOOE				
Transportation Expenses		Php 6, 000.00	Php 5, 250.00	Php 11, 250.00
Honorarium Speaker	1 Trainer x Php 5, 000.00 (Php 5,000 per day for 3 days)		Php 15, 000.00	Php 15, 000.00
Foods for 2 day training (4 snacks and 2 lunch)	35 persons x Php 750.00 (Php 250.00 per day for 3 days including project team)		Php 26, 250.00	Php 26,250.00
Training Materials	25 persons x Php 280.00	Php 7, 000. 00	–	Php 7, 000.00
Per diem of the Ati participants (mandatory based on the IKSP Law)	25 participants x Php 300.00		Php 7, 500.00	Php 7, 500.00
Health Kits (Purchase of face masks shields/ alcohol/ temperature scanner, etc.)	Php 7, 000.00	Php 7, 000.00	-	Php 7, 000.00
TOTAL		Php 20, 000.00	Php 100, 000.00	Php 120, 000.00

X. References

- Biclar, Leo Andrew, Kumbuyanay: Building an Economically Sustainable and Resilient Ati Community Innovative Strategies During the Covid 19 Pandemic. Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=4102928> or <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.4102928>
- Biclar, L. A. B., Lachica, L. P. F., Virtudazo, A. Z., & Latoza, R. J. A. (2022). Indigenous Knowledge System and Practices on Arts and Crafts of Indigenous Peoples in Capiz, Philippines. *Volume 30, No. 1 (2018), 30(1)*.
- Mason, M. C., Floreani, J., Miani, S., Beltrame, F., & Cappelletto, R. (2015). Understanding the impact of entrepreneurial orientation on SMEs' performance. The role of the financing structure. *Procedia Economics and finance*, 23, 1649-1661.